



Stakeholder Perceptions of Machine Translation, Generative AI, and Large Language Models

October 2, 2024

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Agenda

Consumer Preferences

Enterprise Plans and Attitudes

Relationship between AI and Demand
for Language Services

Attitudes about AI (Including MT)

Q&A

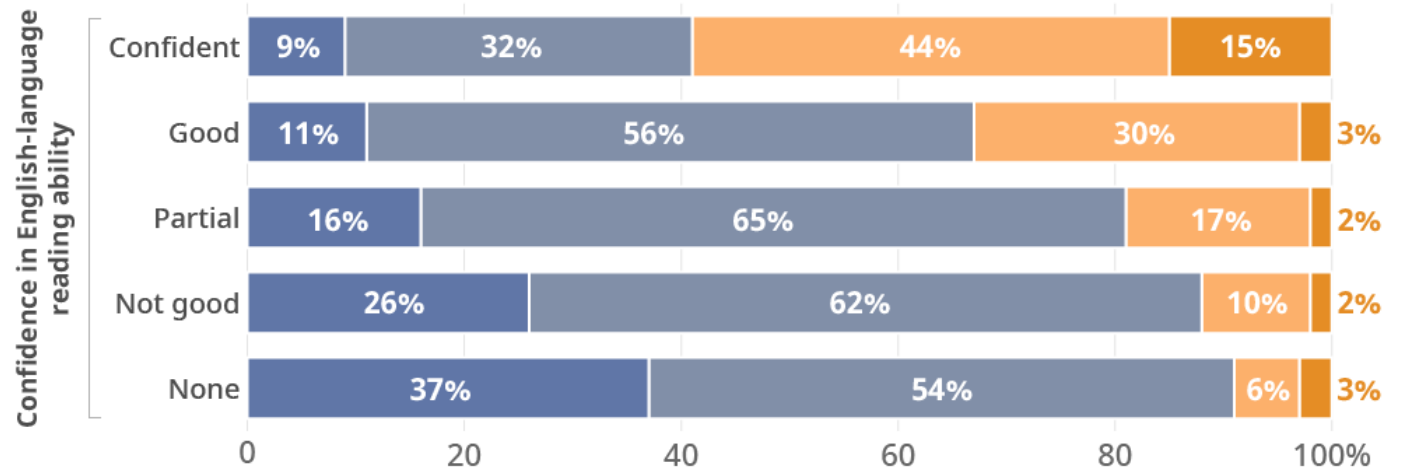
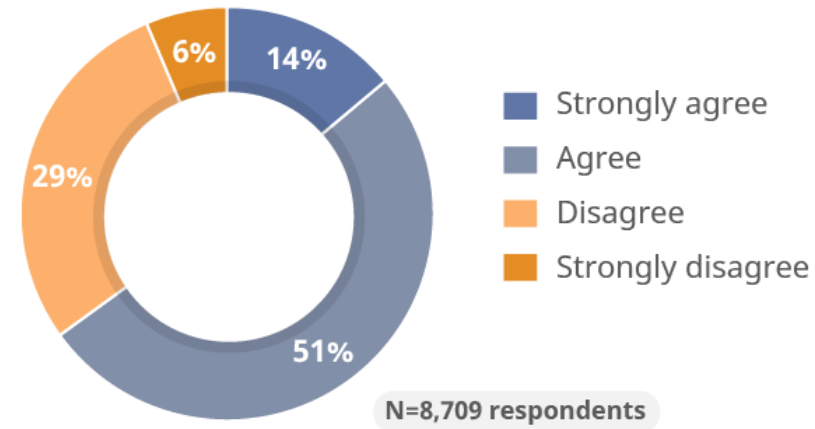
Data sources

- **Quarterly confidence surveys with CEOs of US\$1 million+ LSPs**
(~100 responses per survey)
- **Quarterly confidence surveys with freelancers** (N = 334 to 1,121)
- **Periodic surveys with enterprise buyers of language services** (N = 43)
- **“Can’t Read, Won’t Buy” data from online consumers** (N = 8,709)
- **Perceptions on Automated Interpreting Survey** (N=2,543)
- **Ongoing discussions with CSA Research Councils**

Consumer Preferences

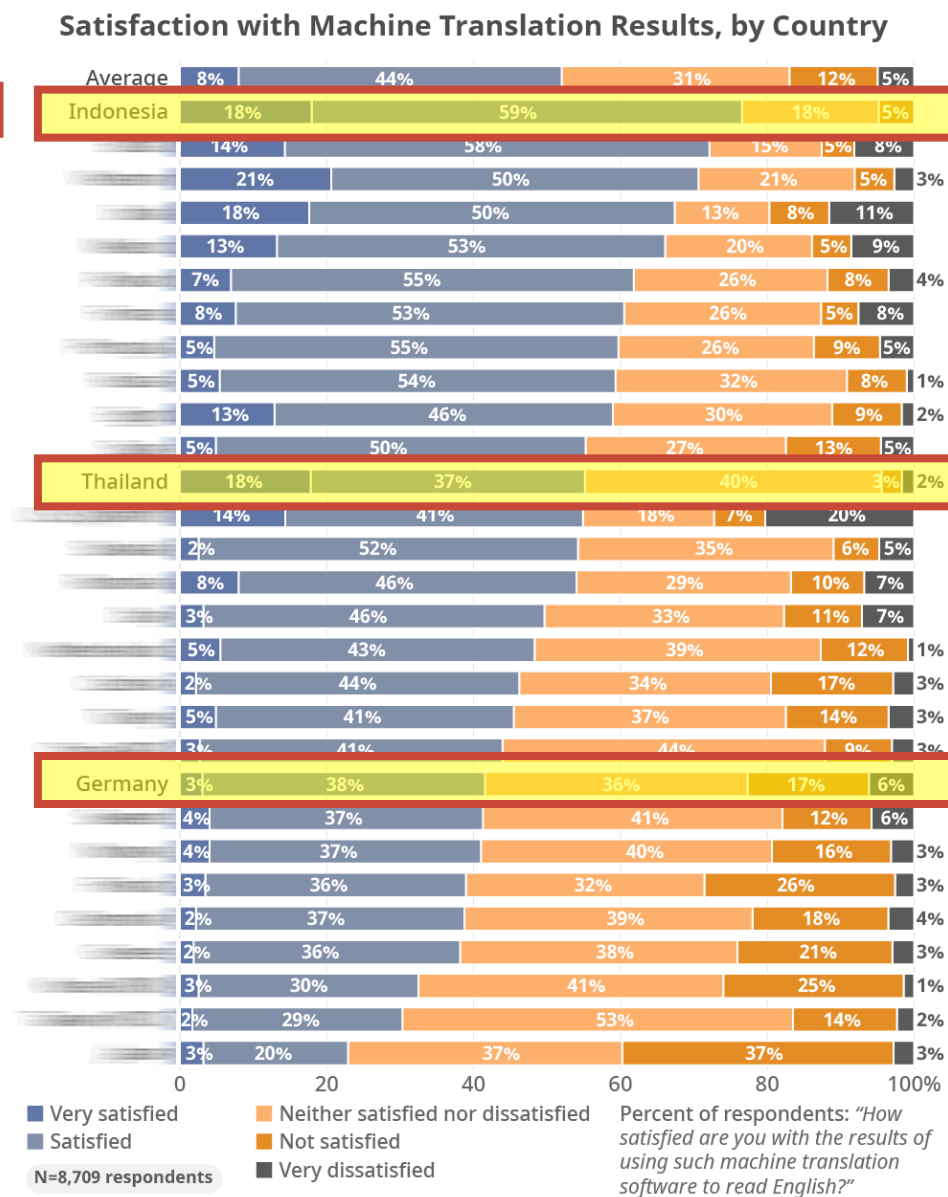
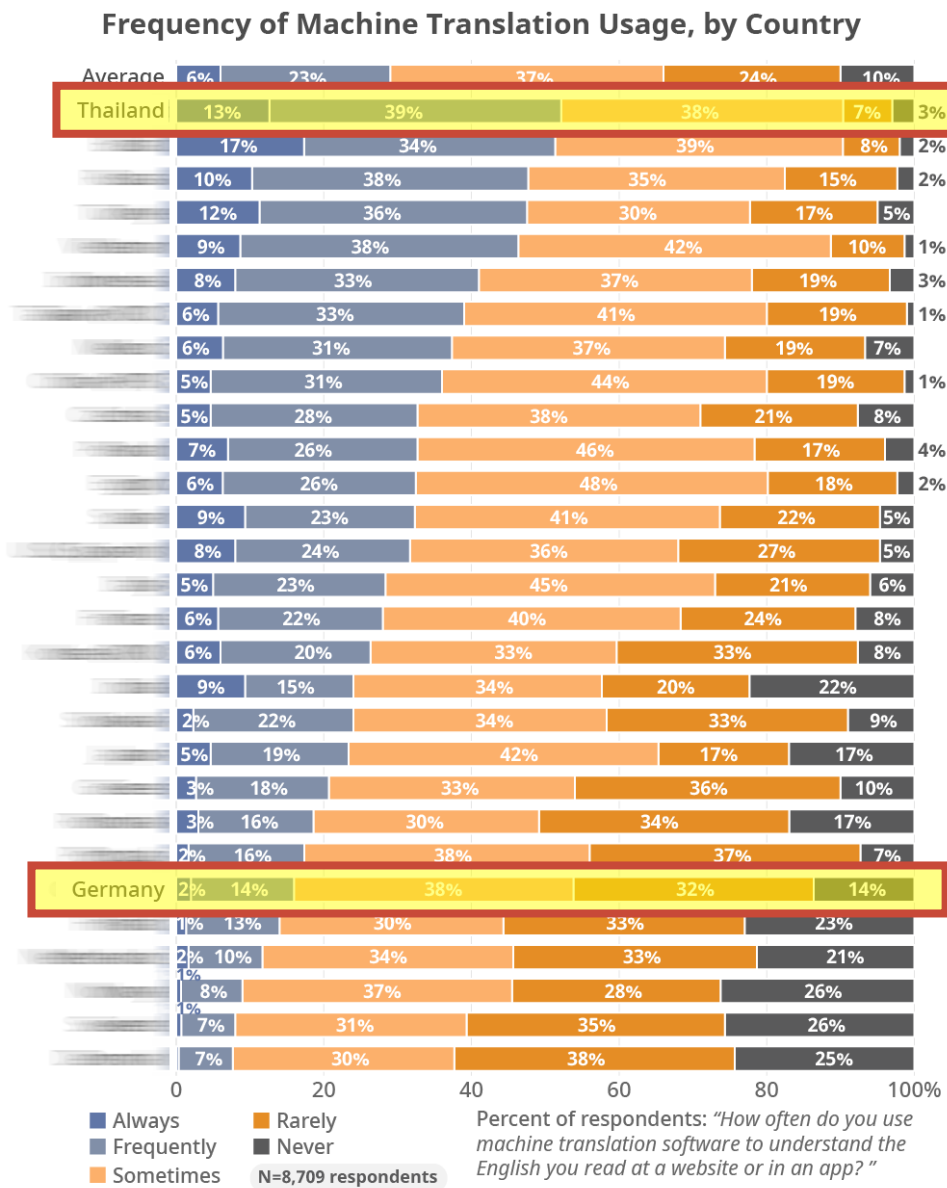
Consumers generally prefer language access over “quality”

I would prefer to have site content in my native language instead of English even if the version in my language is somewhat difficult to understand.



Source: "Can't Read, Won't Buy - B2C"

MT satisfaction is a complex topic



Enterprise Plans and Attitudes

Enterprise expectations of LSPs

What type of support do you expect from your language partners for GenAI?

Q3 2023	Q2 2024	
33%	14%	Innovation and guidance
22%	21%	Quality validation
16%	14%	Generative AI expertise
13%	4%	No expectations or no LSP participation
11%	27%	Efficiencies
5%	4%	Integration

Risk management

Protection

Security

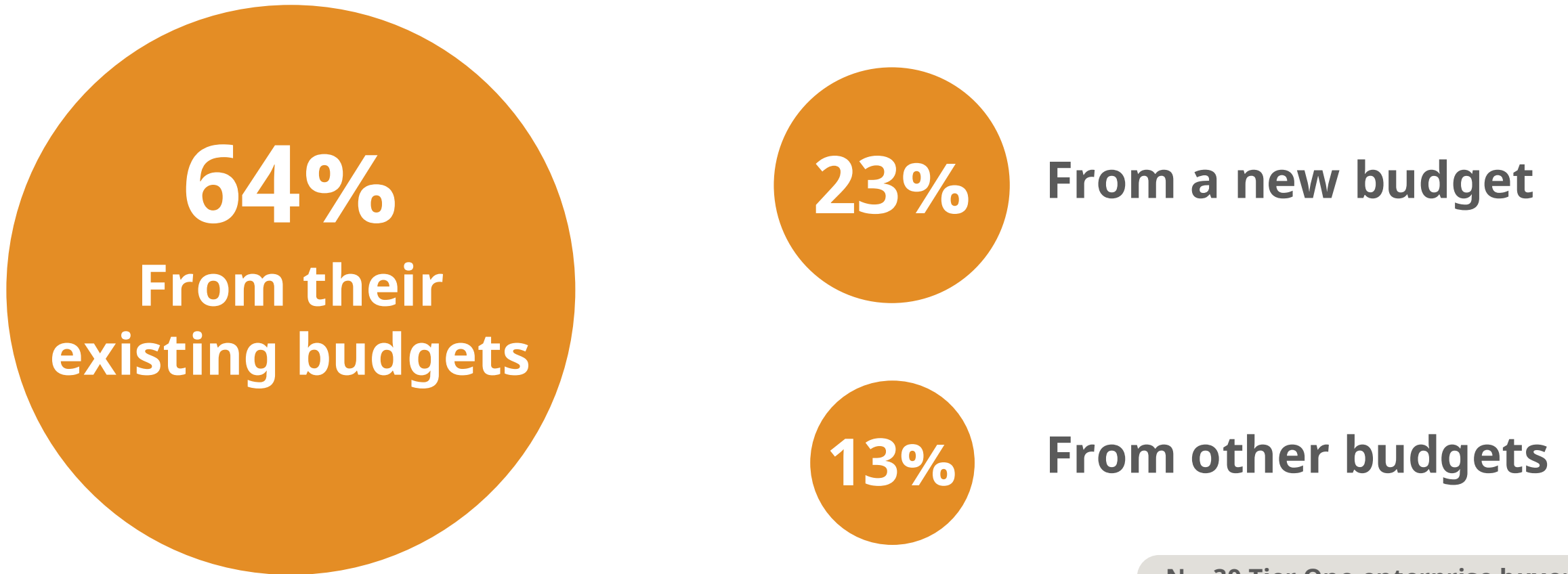
All the “-ities”

Trustworthiness

N = 49 Tier One enterprise buyers

GenAI funding sources

How will you fund GenAI expertise delivered by LSPs?

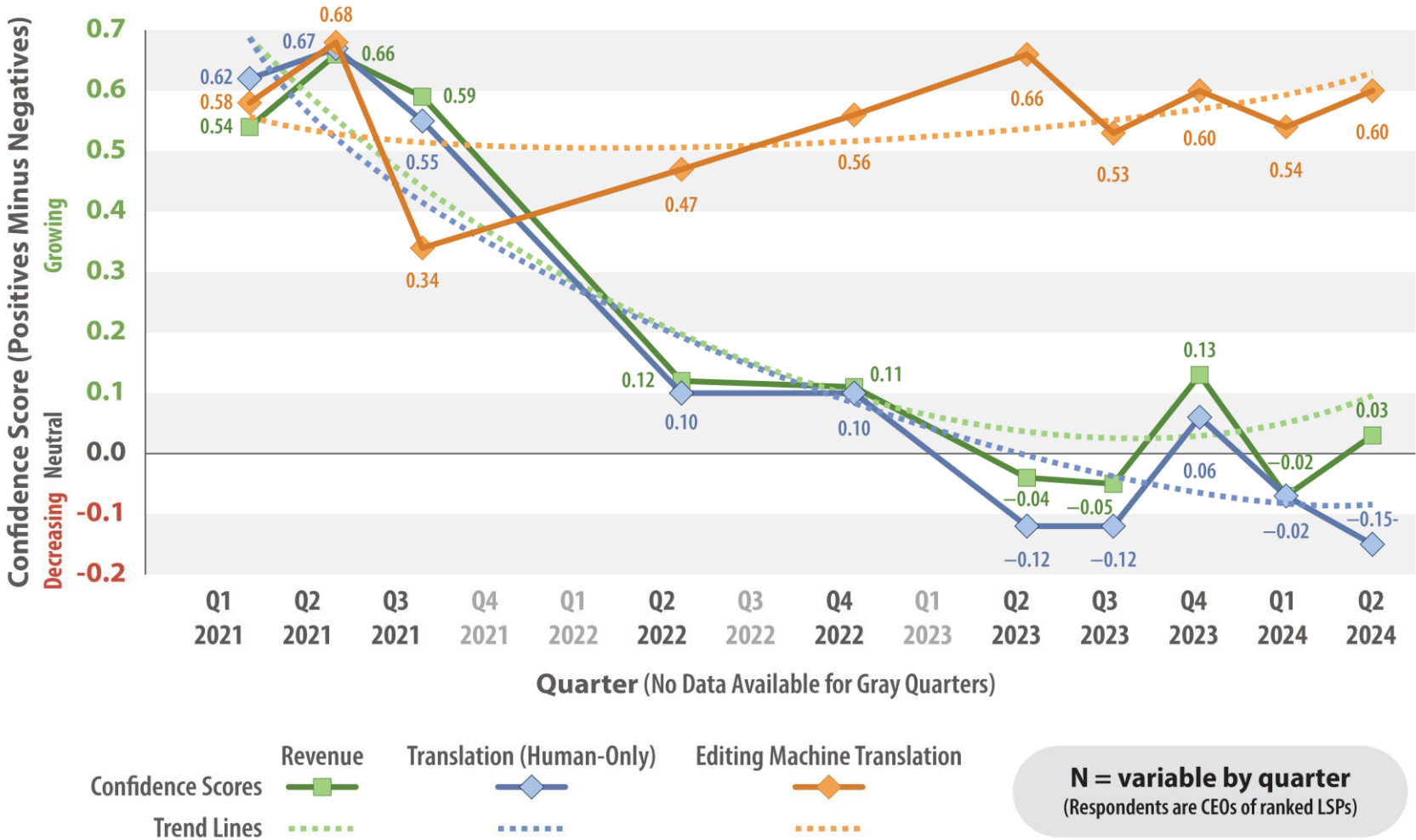


N = 39 Tier One enterprise buyers

Relationship between AI and Demand for Language Services

Human services are declining: Machine are booming

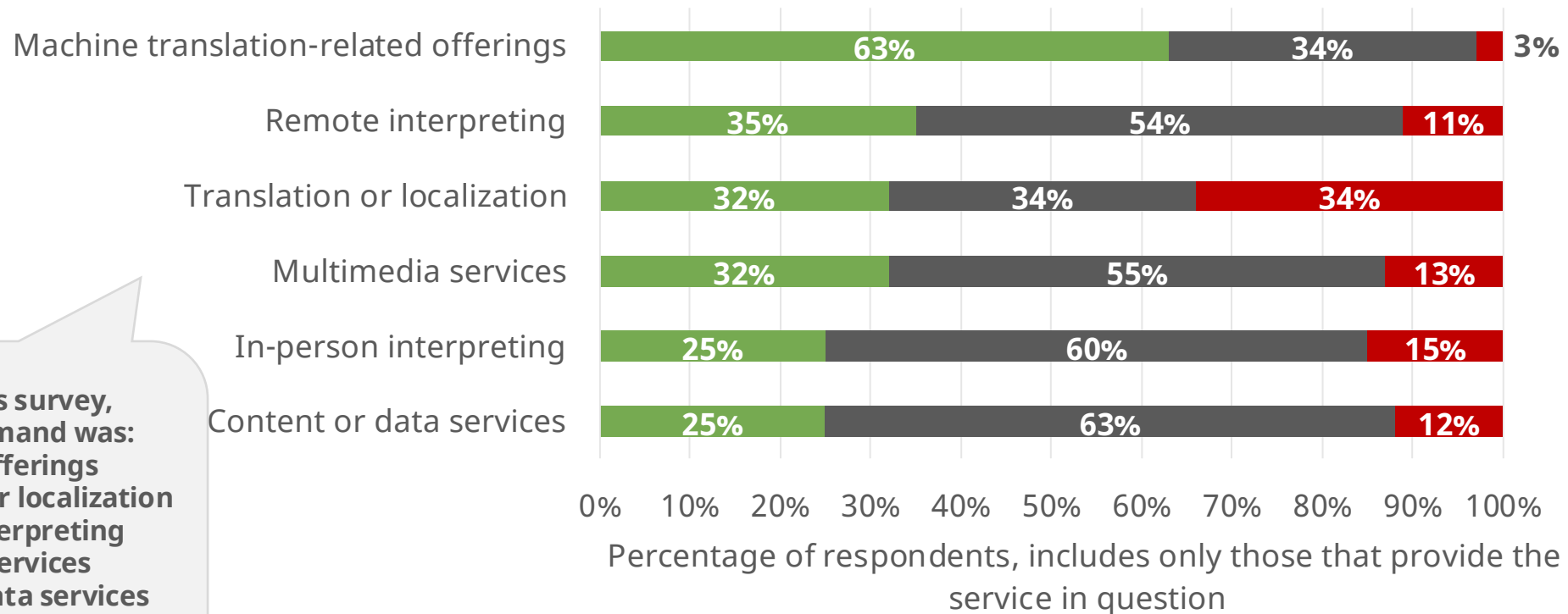
As a median, 80% of the revenue for large LSPs comes from human-only services.



Source: "Q3 2024 Language Services Market Sizing Update"

For five surveys, MT offerings have led in growth

Experience Regarding the Demand for Services



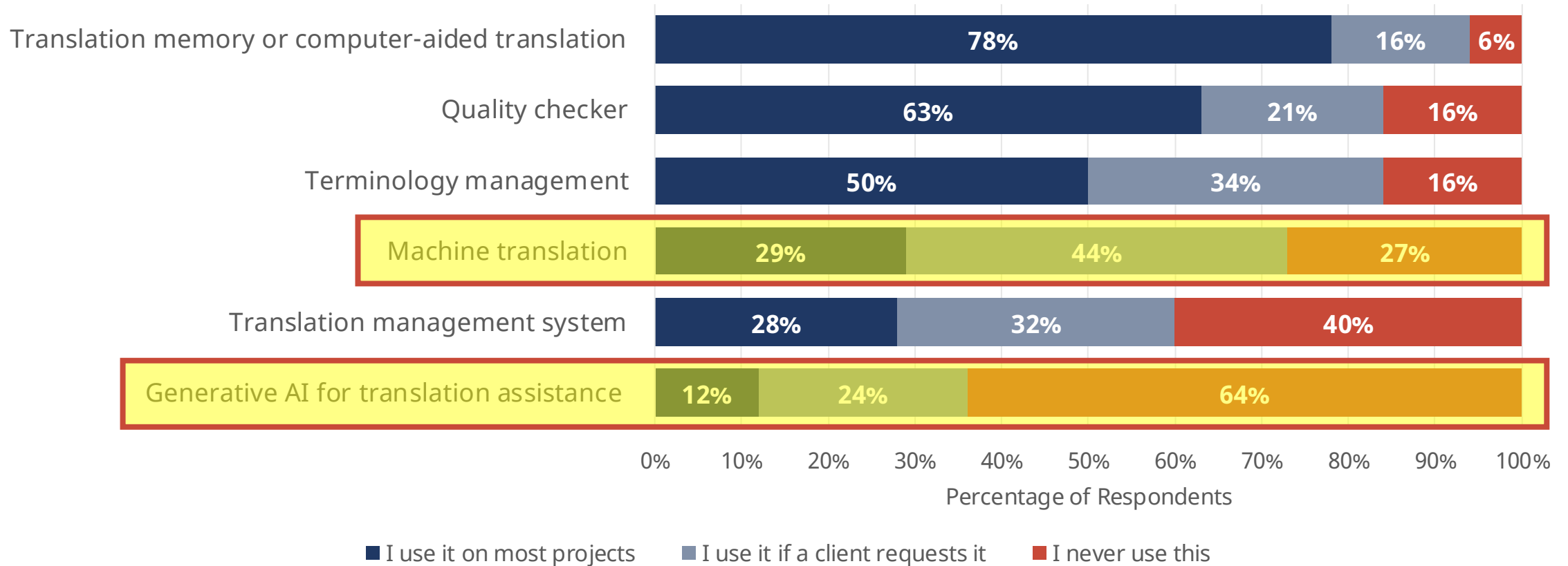
For the previous survey, the order of demand was:
1) MT-related offerings
2) Translation or localization
3) In-person interpreting
4) Multimedia services
5) Content or data services
6) Remote interpreting

■ Up ■ Unchanged ■ Down

Source: "Q1 2024 LSP Confidence Survey"

N = 52 to 100 top LSPs (depending on the service) at the end of Q1 2024

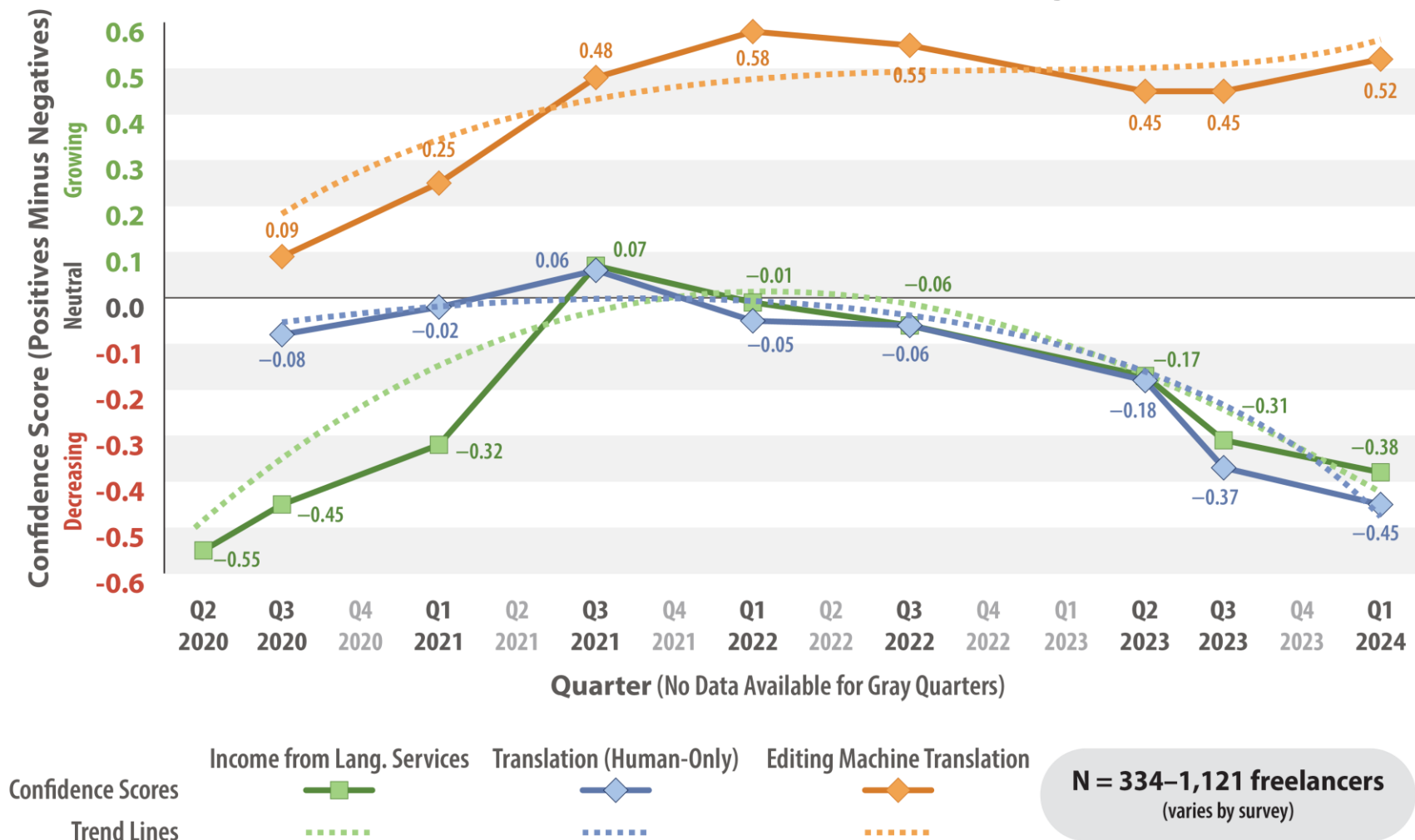
MT and GenAI have significant freelancer adoption



N = 335 freelancers in April 2024

Source: "Freelancers' Use of Technology in 2024"

Freelancers have been affected more by AI

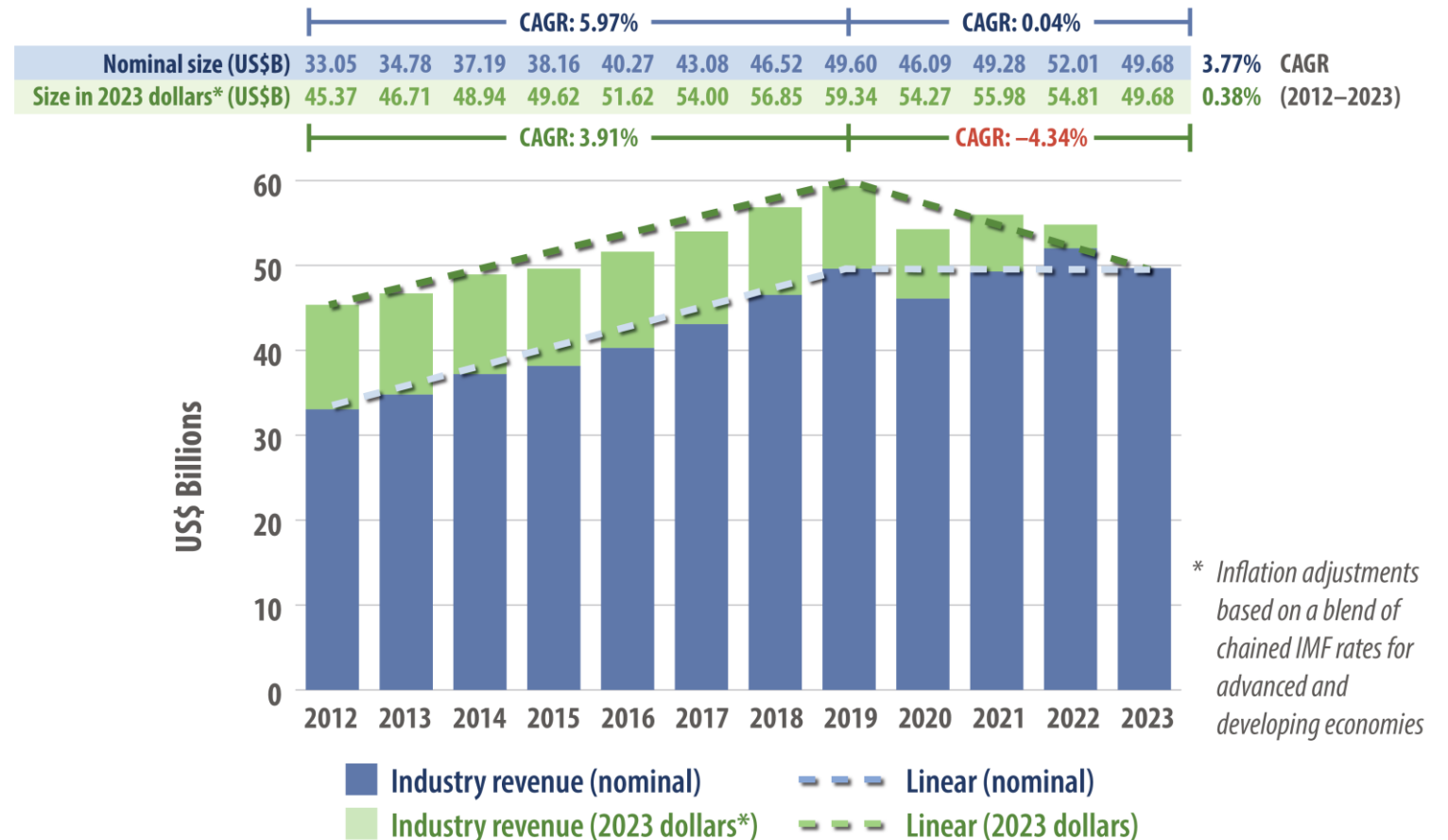


Source: "Q3 2024 Language Services Market Sizing Update"

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Is MT – and other AI – beneficial for industry revenue?

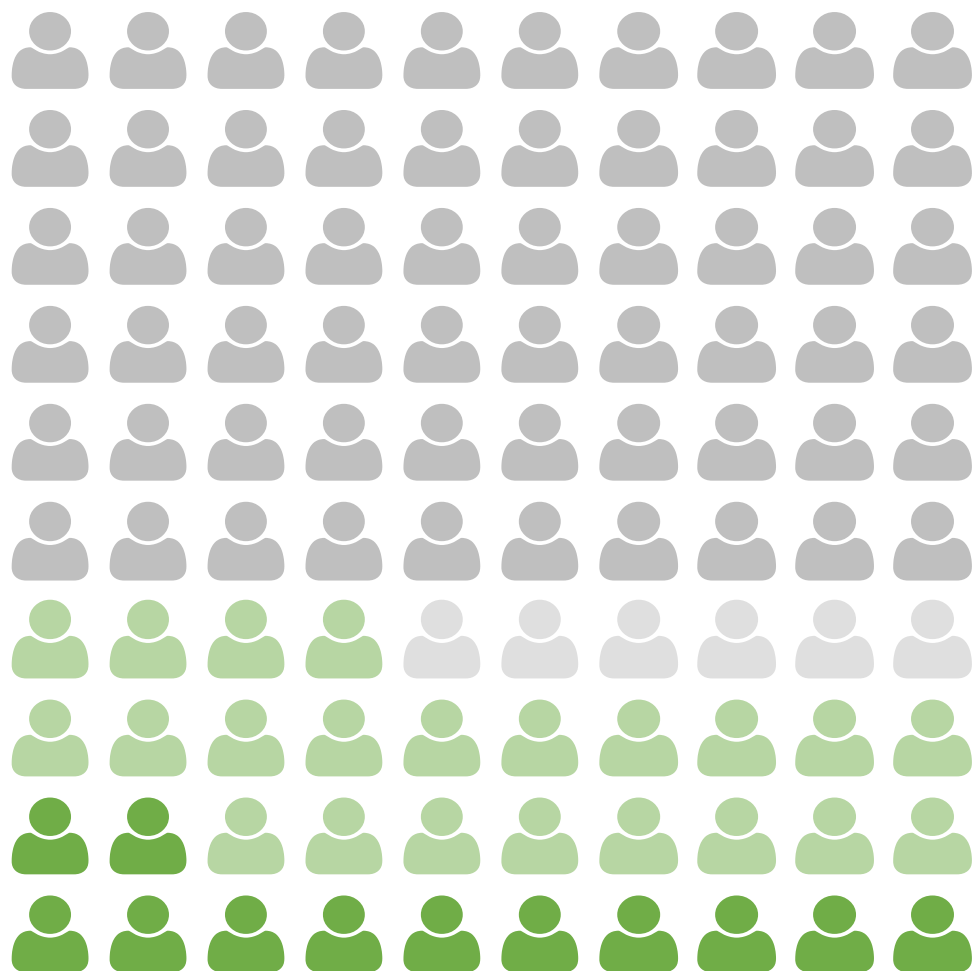
- It's complicated...
- So far, the industry has not seen a huge "AI bump"
- We predict that it will benefit industry revenues



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Source: "Q3 2024 Language Services Market Sizing Update"

Attitudes about AI (including MT)



Based on 101 answers from top LSP CEOs

LSPs

"The cost to implement AI is too high"

34%

12%

Strongly agree

22%

Agree

**Not available for
freelancers**

Source: "Q1 2024 LSP Confidence Survey"



Based on 101 answers from top LSP CEOs

LSPs: “Clients only want automation to reduce costs”

62%

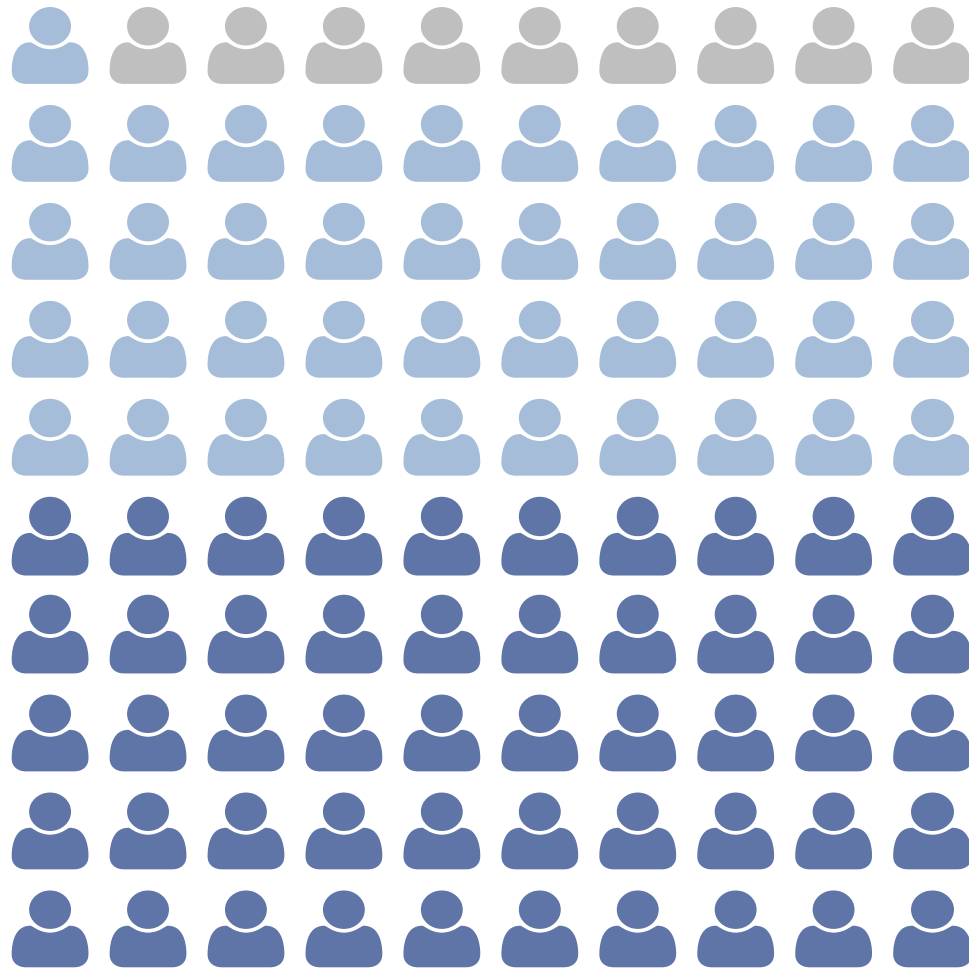
25% 

Strongly agree

37% 

Agree

Source: “Q1 2024 LSP Confidence Survey”



Based on 353 answers from freelancers

Freelancers: “Clients only want automation to reduce costs”

91%

+29

50% 

Strongly agree

+25

41% 

Agree

+4

Source: “Freelancers’ Use of Technology in 2024”



LSPs

“I welcome AI tools as a way to make our work more efficient”

89%

45% 

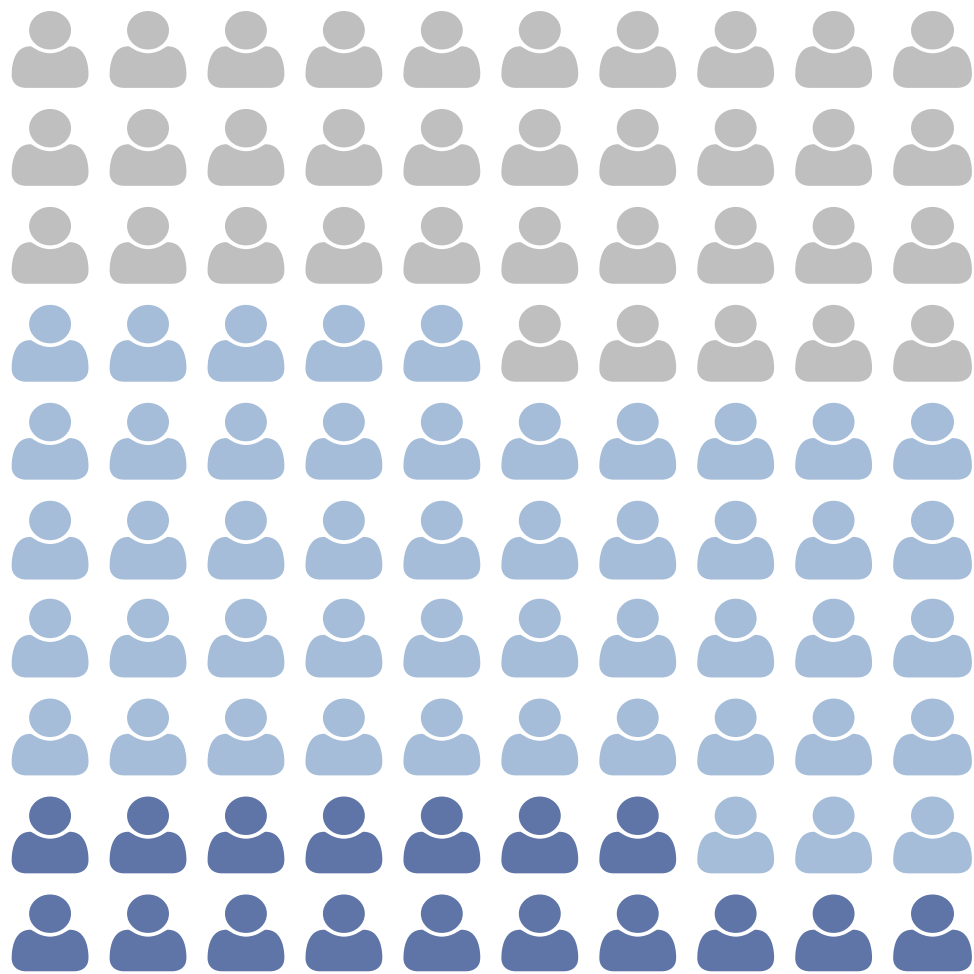
Strongly agree

44% 

Agree

Based on 101 answers from top LSP CEOs

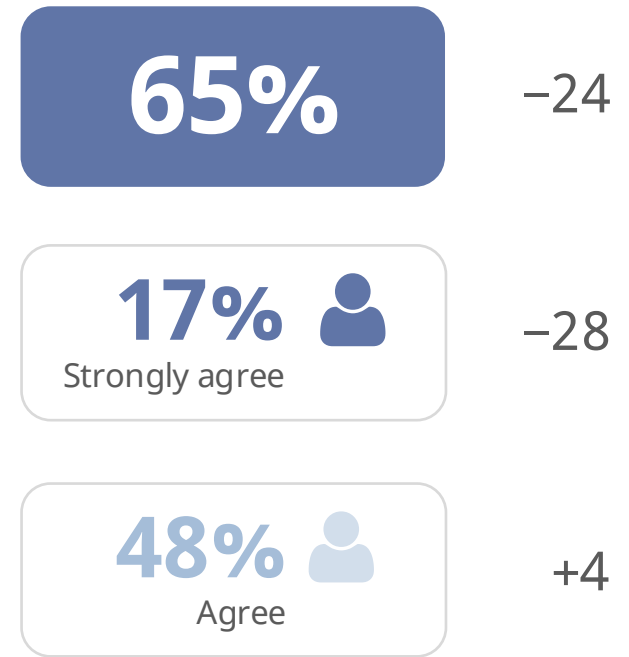
Source: “Q1 2024 LSP Confidence Survey”



Based on 353 answers from freelancers

Freelancers:

“I welcome AI tools as a way to make my work more efficient”



Source: “Freelancers’ Use of Technology in 2024”

LSPs

**“Having a machine translate/
interpret/dub is better than
offering no language support”**

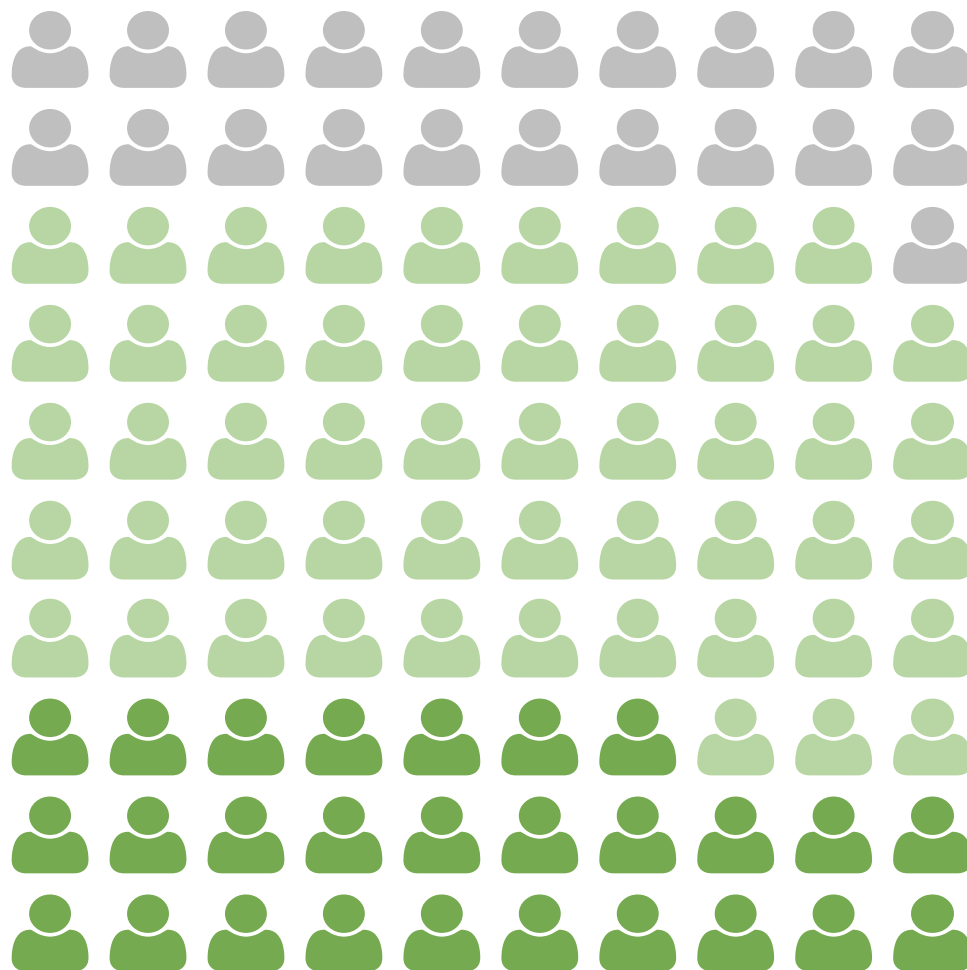
79%

27% 

Strongly agree

52% 

Agree

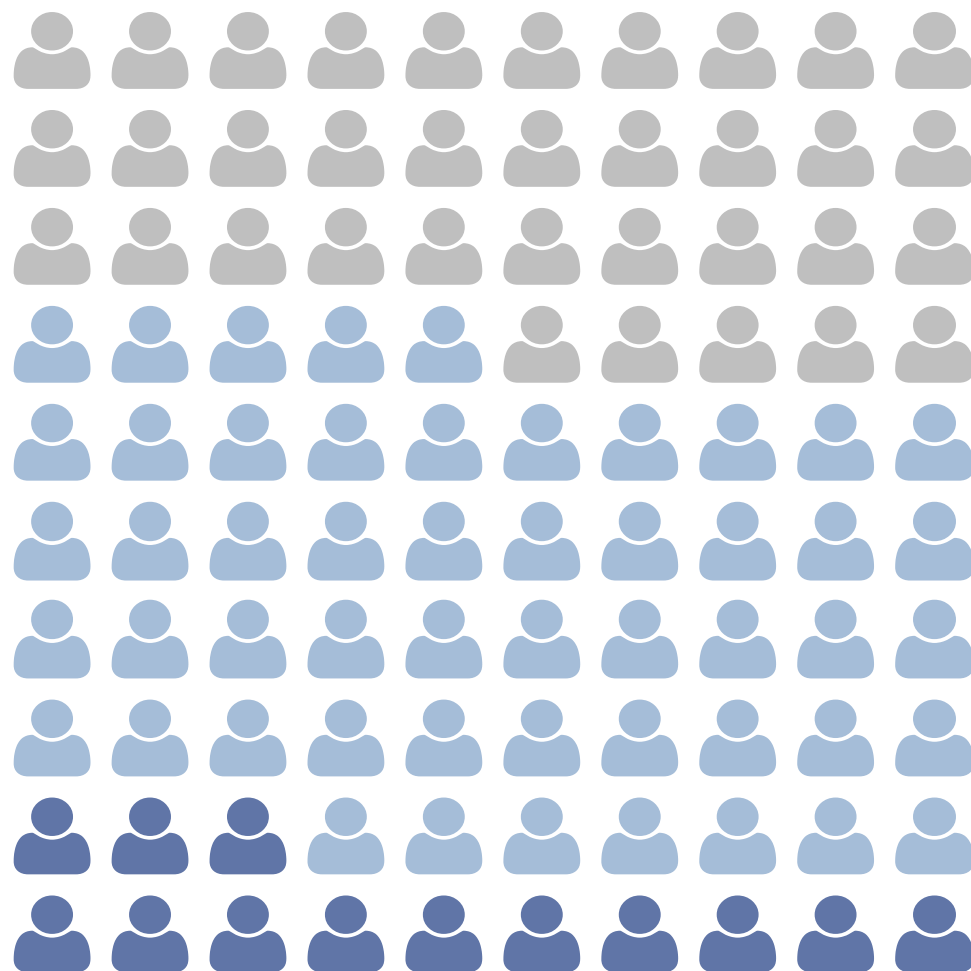


Based on 101 answers from top LSP CEOs

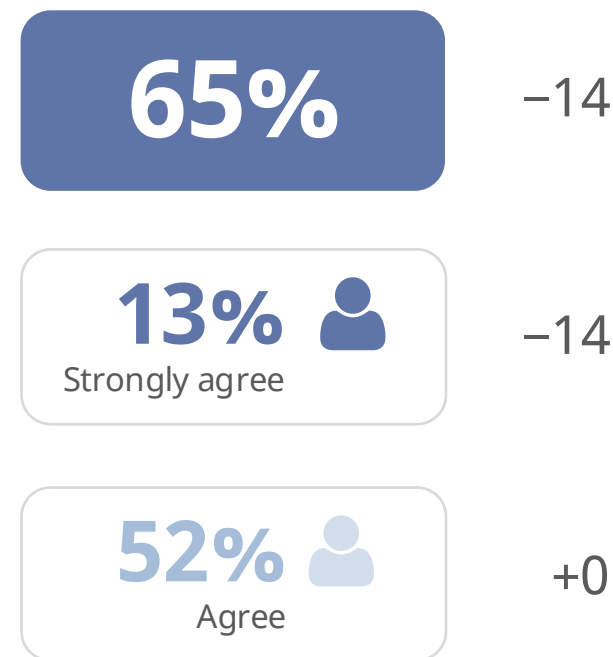
Source: “Q1 2024 LSP Confidence Survey”

Freelancers

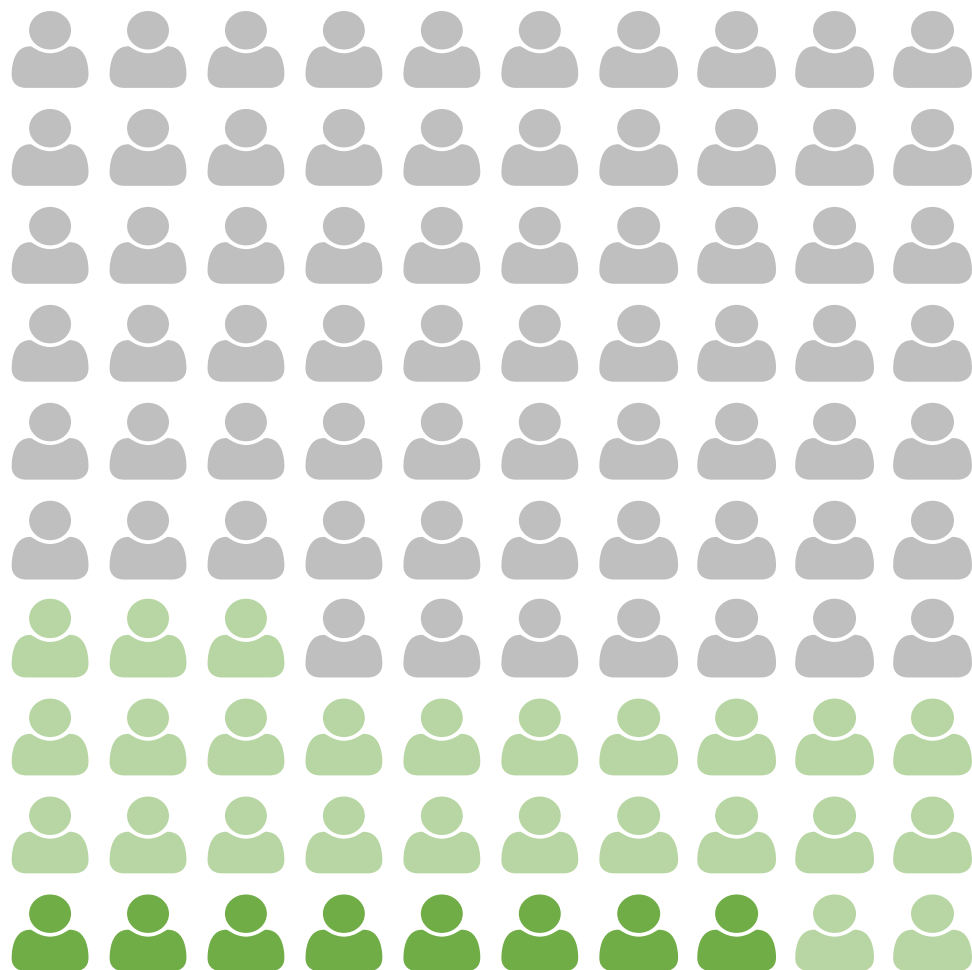
“Having a machine translate/interpret/dub is better than offering no language support”



Based on 353 answers from freelancers



Source: “Freelancers’ Use of Technology in 2024”



LSPs

"It's not right to replace people with machines"

33%

8%

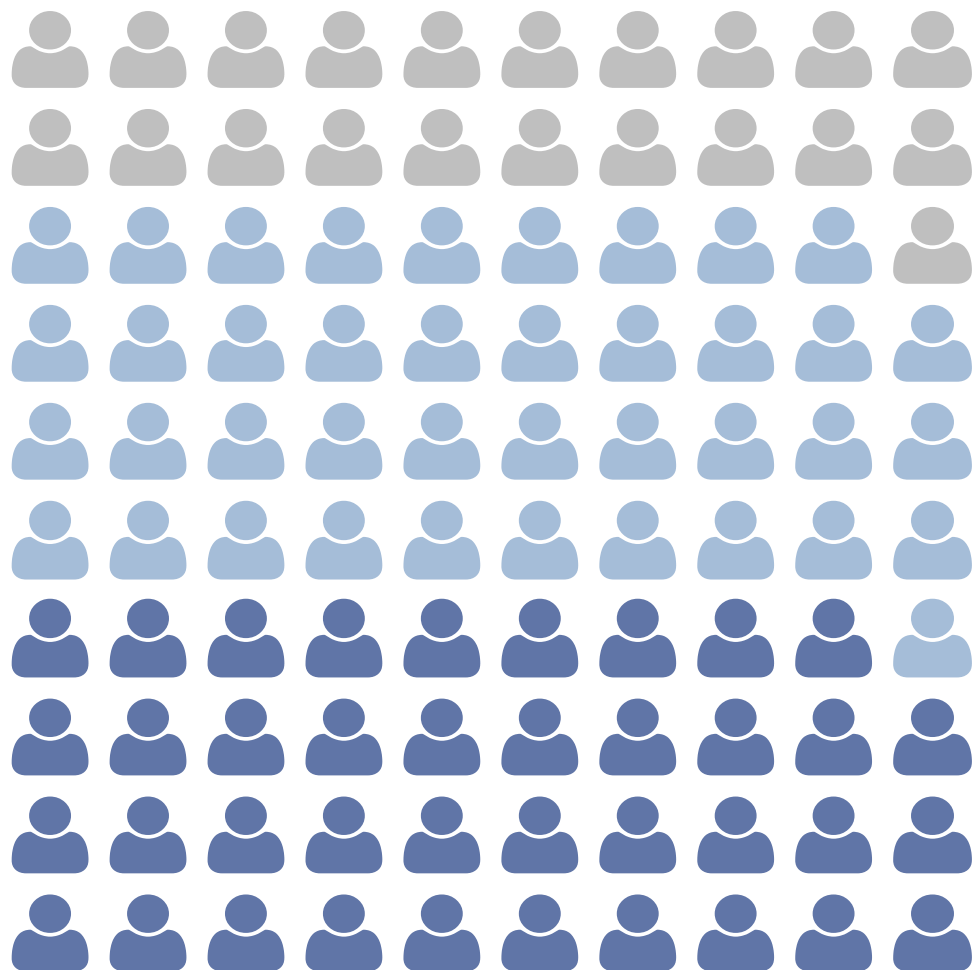
Strongly agree

25%

Agree

Based on 101 answers from top LSP CEOs

Source: "Q1 2024 LSP Confidence Survey"



Based on 353 answers from freelancers

Freelancers: “It's not right to replace people with machines”

79%

+46

39%

Strongly agree

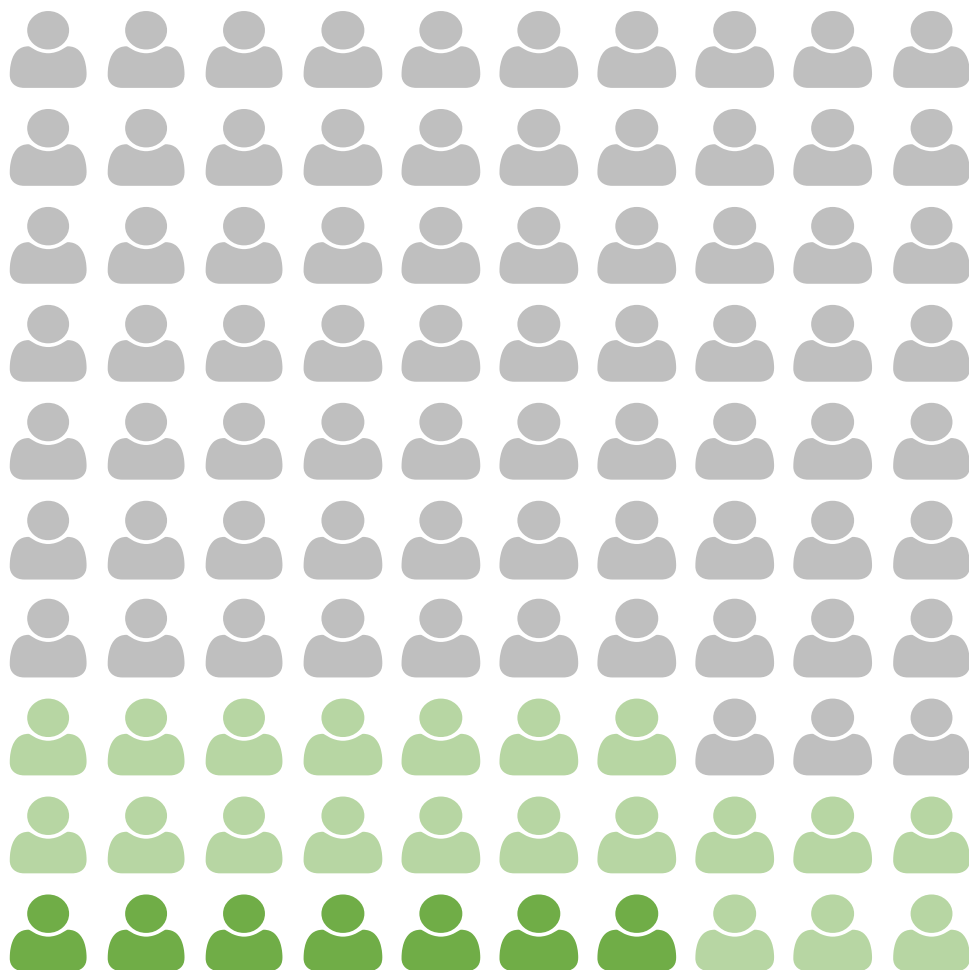
+31

40%

Agree

+15

Source: “Freelancers’ Use of Technology in 2024”



LSPs

"I am afraid AI will take over the job of language professionals"

27%

7% 

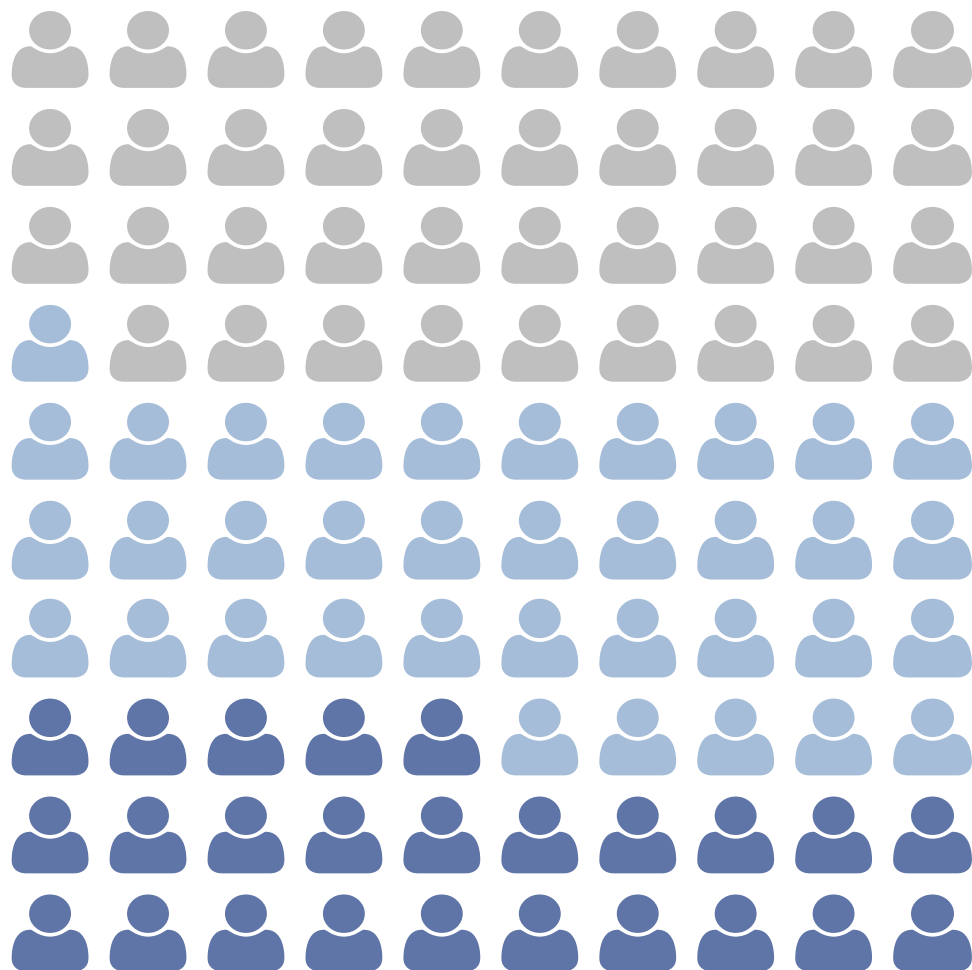
Strongly agree

20% 

Agree

Based on 101 answers from top LSP CEOs

Source: "Q1 2024 LSP Confidence Survey"



Based on 353 answers from freelancers

Freelancers: “I am afraid AI will take over my job”

61%

+34

25%

Strongly agree

+18

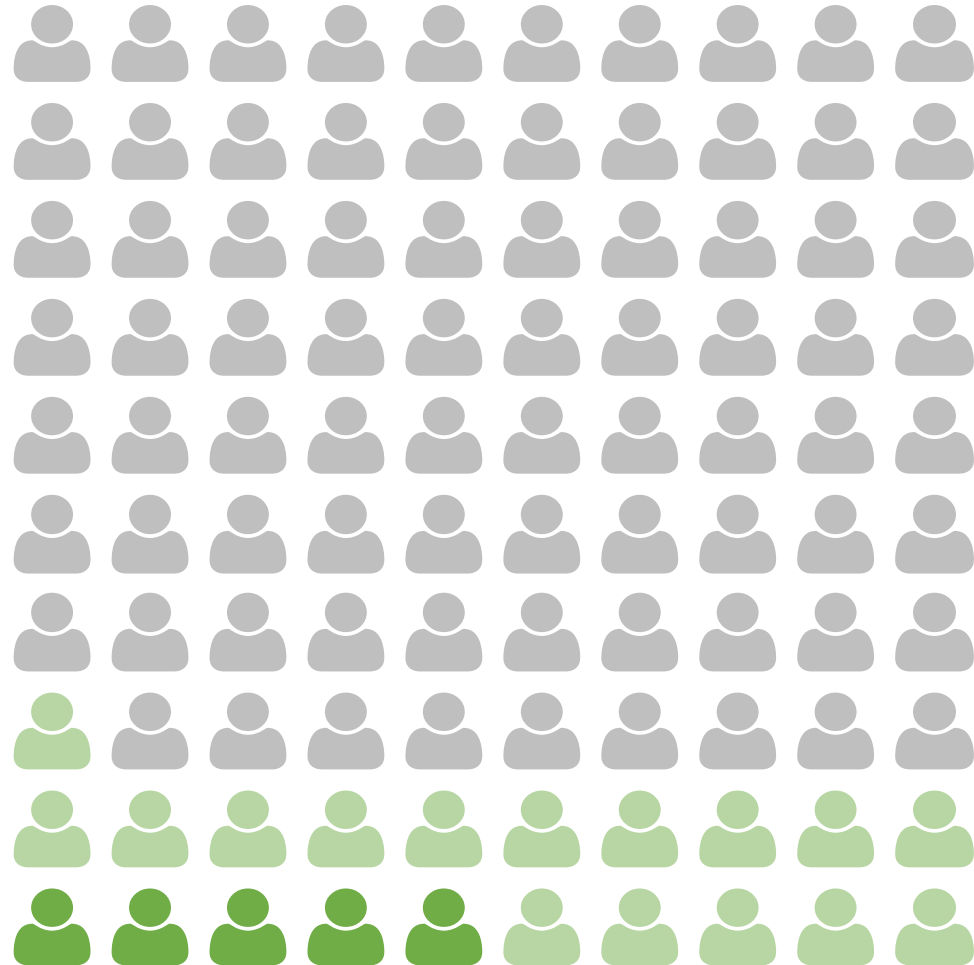
36%

Agree

+16

Source: “Freelancers’ Use of Technology in 2024”

"AI is making it harder to find and retain top talent"



21%

5% 

Strongly agree

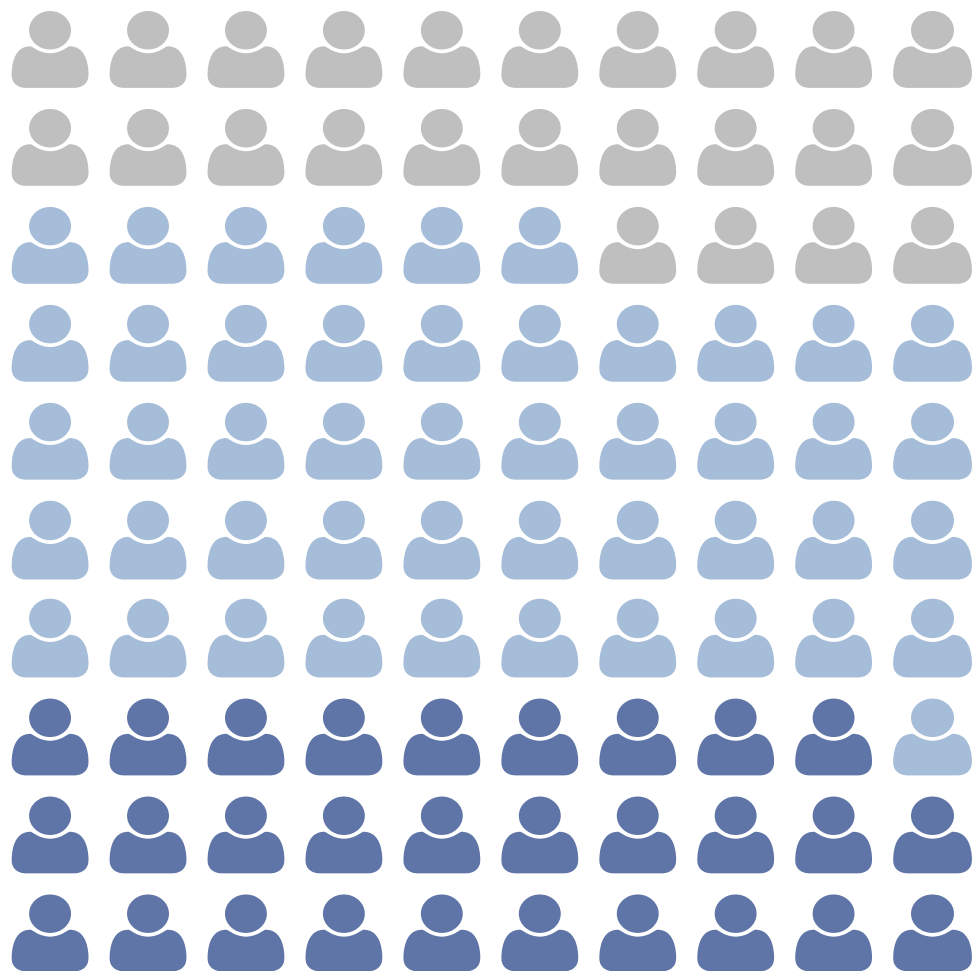
16% 

Agree

**Not available for
freelancers**

Based on 101 answers from top LSP CEOs

Source: "Q1 2024 LSP Confidence Survey"



Based on 353 answers from freelancers

Freelancers

"I am impressed by the progress that AI has made in my field"

76%

29%

Strongly agree

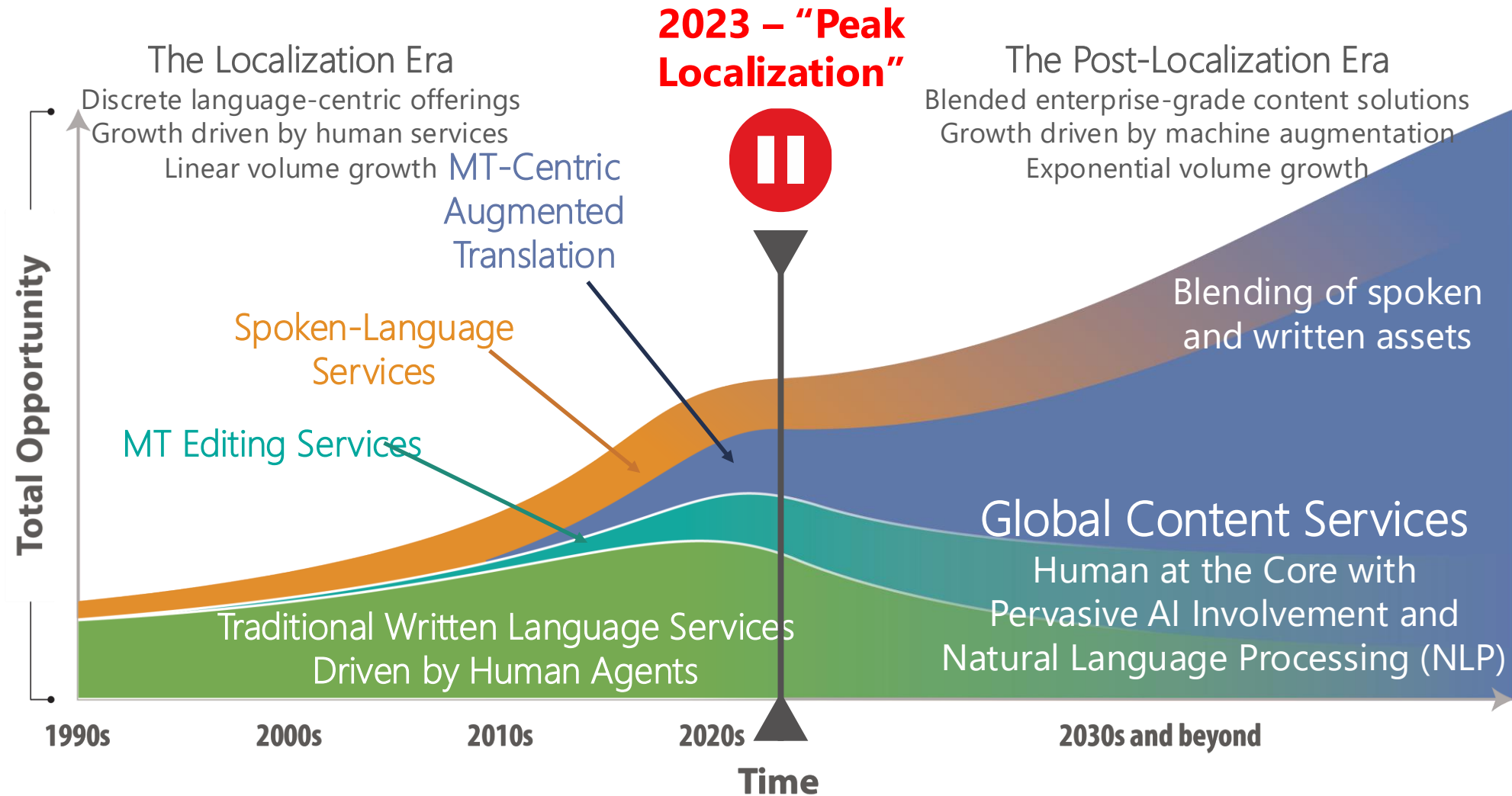
47%

Agree

Not available for
LSPs

Source: "Freelancers' Use of Technology in 2024"

The Post-Localization Era



**It's not too late to get
back on track!**

Thank you!

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